

How we Test

It looks good and the technology is glitzy, but does it do the job?

The Digital Media Test & Research Centre (DMTRC) conducts a series of elaborate tests to evaluate the merit of each hardware and software product. To ensure that our readers have all the information they need to make an informed buying decision, engineers at DMTRC evaluate and review the latest hardware, software and technology services in accordance with the most up-to-date evaluation processes and methodologies used around the world.

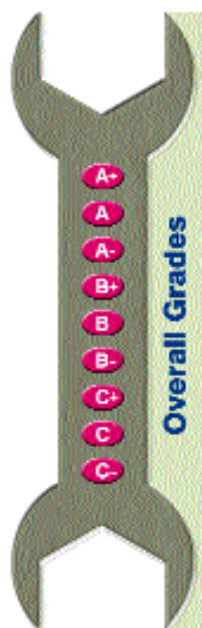
Comparison Tests

We use a dual rating system, the first of which is applied to the Comparison Tests in which we compare the performance of products within a particular category.

Each product is evaluated under different parameters such as performance, value for money, features, warranty and support, etc.

Weightages are then applied to the various test parameters according to their importance for that particular category of products.

These weightages are then used to arrive at an overall grade for each individual product. An overall grade of A+, therefore, indicates that the product is close to perfection.



The Awards

Digit awards outstanding products by selecting a Best Performance and Best Value winner in each comparison test. The winner of the Best Performance Award will be the product that scored the highest in the performance segment of our tests.

This award represents the best performing product in our tests and doesn't factor in any other parameter such as value for money, features, support, etc. The winner of the Best Value Award will be the product that scores the highest in our value for money parameter which is derived



taking into account the ratio of a product's performance and features to its price. The product winning this award offers good performance at a great price.

In Bazaar

The second part of the rating system is used to evaluate individual hardware and software products in the Bazaar section. The evaluation covers parameters such as performance, ease of use, value for money and the build quality/features of the product in question and then arrives at an overall rating.

Here each of these parameters is given a weightage of 25 per cent and is rated on a scale of 5, which is represented by arrows (▶).

The greater the number of arrows, the better the product. This simple five-point rating system is designed to give you an easy-to-interpret assessment of a product. For example, a product that receives an overall score of five arrows signifies an outstanding buy!

The 5-point Rating System used in Bazaar

▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	Excellent: A brilliant combination of price, performance and features—far beyond expectations
▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	Good: A good buy, better than most products in its category
▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	Average: Reasonably competent but nothing spectacular about the product
▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	Mediocre: Does not live up to expectations, needs improvement in many areas
▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	Poor: has serious drawbacks and needs improvement before it can be used for its target application



In Test this Month

This month, delight yourself with the best display in town. Here's a mammoth test comprising of 14 CRT and 23 LCD monitors. LCD monitors are a good deal for those who do not want to take up



much desk space. Of course, there is always the 17-inch and the 19-inch CRTs that are economically viable. Variety is the flavour of the month in Bazaar. Keeping that in mind, we appease the appetite of the audiophile by reviewing Bose Mediamate Speakers. Also served up is the Apacer Audio Steno and the striking Apple iPod MP3 player that comes with a huge 30 GB drive to dump your favourite numbers into. Wanna go mobile? Check out Samsung and Phillips' latest offering.

Also reviewed is the Seagate's latest offering—the Serial ATA 80 GB drive. Take a look at the CD-RWs that might just lure you into buying them. For the tech savvy, we have the DigiCard Holder, the Sony CLIE handheld and a desktop laptop! What's more! Take a look at how e-Monitor and e-Monitor Pro helps you to catch the Judas in your organization!

